

Christ Full Deity

doc-christ-full-deity

Christology · Person · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

breadth canon-wide
directness direct
variants stable

Statement under examination

Jesus Christ is fully and uniquely God, eternally begotten and not created, equal in essence with the Father.

In plain language

Six anchor texts apply the Greek word for God, 'God' (theos), and identity formulae to Jesus in ways the grammar marks as real claims of deity, not polite titles. In John 1:1 the queried word order is decisive: the word 'God' (theos) stands before the verb 'was', and the subject 'the Word' (ho logos) comes after it, which in this language signals a quality (the Word fully shares the divine nature), not an indefinite 'a god'. John 8:58 sets a verb of coming to be ('to come into being' / genesthai, a completed past action), used for Abraham, against a bare present 'I am' (eimi), used for Jesus with nothing completing it, echoing the divine self-naming behind Exodus 3:14 ('I AM' / ehyeh). John 20:28 has Thomas say to him, 'my Lord and my God' (ho kyrios mou kai ho theos mou), with the narrator marking it as address ('said to him' / eipen auto) and Jesus not refusing it. Colossians 2:9 uses a word that appears only once in the whole New Testament, 'deity' (theotes), and says the entire 'fullness' (pleroma) of it lives in Christ 'bodily' (somatikos) and permanently. Hebrews 1:8 has the Father address the Son as 'the God' (ho theos) on an everlasting throne. Philippians 2:6 says Christ was in 'the form of God' (morphe theou) and counted 'being equal with God' (to einai isa theo) not a thing to grasp, using the same equality word (isa) his opponents use against him in John 5:18. Why do some readers still divide? Their strongest moves are real grammar: 'God' (theos) in John 1:1 lacks the article 'the' (anarthrous), John 20:28 could in theory be an outburst, and words like 'firstborn' (prototokos) and 'only begotten' (monogenes) can suggest origin. Each move is answered from the words themselves: the article pattern is the quality construction, the narrator says Thomas spoke to him, 'firstborn' is paired with creating all things, and 'only begotten' (monogenes) is used of Isaac who was not an only child by birth. One link is genuinely thin: 'deity' (theotes) and its near twin 'divine quality' (theiotes) each appear only once, so their difference rests on word formation rather than on repeated usage. But the other anchors carry the weight on their own, and the pattern spans many authors and both Testaments, which is why it lands as a confident yes.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0011	Ἀβραάμ	Abraam	Abraham	
G0281	ἀμήν	amēn	amen	
G0725	ἅρπαγμός	harpagmos	something to grasp	1
G1096	γίνομαι	ginomai	to be	697
G1473	ἐγώ	egō	I/we	
G1510	εἰμί	eimi	to be	2,457
G2118	εὐθύτης	euthytes	righteousness	1

G2305	θειότης	theiotes	divinity	1
G2316	θεός	theos	God	1,311
G2320	θεότης	theotes	deity	1
G2362	θρόνος	thronos	throne	64
G2381	Θωμᾶς	Thōmas	Thomas	
G2470	ἴσος	isos	equal	8
G2730	κατοικέω	katoikeo	to dwell	45
G3056	λόγος	logos	word	339
G3439	μονογενής	monogenes	unique	9
G3444	μορφή	morphe	form	3
G3588	ὁ	ho	the/this/who	
G3956	πᾶς	pas	all	
G4138	πλήρωμα	pleroma	fulfillment	17
G4250	πρίν	prin	before	
G4314	πρός	pros	to/with	
G4416	πρωτότοκος	prototokos	firstborn	8
G4464	ῥάβδος	rhabdos	rod	12
G4985	σωματικῶς	somatikos	bodily	1
G5207	υἱός	huios	son	386
G5225	ὑπάρχω	hyparcho	be already	60

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Across distinct authors (the writings of John, Paul, and Hebrews) the word 'God' (theos, Strong's G2316, which occurs 1311 times in the queried Greek New Testament) and identity formulae attach to Jesus in ways the queried morphology (the grammatical tagging of every word form) marks as non-attributive (not a mere descriptive label). John 1:1c orders the tokens with 'God' (theos) without the article 'the' (anarthrous, N-NSM meaning noun nominative singular masculine) placed before the linking verb 'was' (en, the copula) with 'the Word' (ho logos, articular meaning carrying 'the', N-NSM) coming after. This is the qualitative predicate-nominative construction (a noun completing a 'X is Y' statement that ascribes a quality), not the indefinite 'a god'. John 8:58 sets the completed-action infinitive 'to come into being' (genesthai, an aorist meaning a completed past action, applied to Abraham coming to be) against the bare ongoing-present 'I am' (eimi, a present indicative meaning an ongoing simple statement of fact, with no predicate complement). John 20:28 records that Thomas 'said to him' (eipen auto, with auto being a dative meaning a 'to-him' grammatical form) as 'the Lord of me and the God of me' (ho kyrios kai ho theos, both articular meaning carrying 'the'). Colossians 2:9 predicates the continuous-state verb 'dwells' (katoikei, durative meaning ongoing) of 'all the fullness of the deity' (pan to pleroma tes theotetos, with theotetos from G2320, a hapax meaning a word that occurs only once in the entire New Testament) 'bodily' (somatikos). Hebrews 1:8 has the Father address the Son as 'the God' (ho theos) with an eternal throne. Philippians 2:6 says 'form of God' (morphe theou) and 'to be equal with God' (to einai isa theo, with isa from G2470, the same word the opponents use in John 5:18 to accuse Jesus). The minority readings each rest on one grammatical move that the wider queried canon independently blunts. Old Testament roots (Exodus 3:14 'I AM' / 'I will be' (ehyeh), Psalm 45:6 'God' (elohim)) supply grounding spread across the whole Bible (pan-canonical).

Scripture

John.1.1 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3056 λόγος, G2316 θεός, G1510 εἰμί, G4314 πρὸς

Force. Queried token order in John 1:1: clause two reads 'and the Word was with the God' (kai ho logos en pros ton theon), where 'the God' (ton theon) is articular accusative (with the article 'the', the T-ASM plus N-ASM tags meaning article and noun in the accusative or 'direct-object' form, masculine singular) paired with the relational preposition 'toward / with' (pros), naming the Father. Clause three reads 'and God was the Word' (kai theos en ho logos): the predicate (the completing noun) 'God' (theos, N-NSM meaning noun nominative singular masculine, position 14) stands BEFORE the past-continuous linking verb 'was' (en, the imperfect copula, V-IAI-3S meaning verb imperfect active indicative third person singular, position 15), and the subject 'the Word' (ho logos, the article at position 16 plus the noun N-NSM at position 17) follows. A predicate noun without the article 'the' (anarthrous) fronted ahead of the linking verb with a subject that does carry 'the' (articular) is the qualitative construction (the Word has the divine nature), not an indefinite 'a god'. The past-ongoing 'was' (en, the imperfect, an ongoing or repeated past action) places the Word (Logos) in eternity, distinct in person from 'the God' (ho theos) of clause two.

John.8.58 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4250 πρίν, G0011 Ἀβραάμ, G1096 γίνομαι, G1473 ἐγώ, G1510 εἰμί

Force. John 8:58 reads 'before Abraham came to be, I am' (prin Abraam genesthai ego eimi). The queried morphological tags confirm 'to come into being' (genesthai) is V-2ADN (an aorist infinitive, that is, an infinitive of completed past action) applied to Abraham, set against 'I am' (eimi) tagged V-PAI-1S (present indicative active first person singular, an ongoing simple statement of fact) predicated of Jesus with NO predicate complement (no noun or phrase completing the 'I am'). A normal temporal contrast would expect a past-ongoing 'was' (an imperfect, ongoing or repeated past action) or a complement, so the bare present functions as absolute predication, echoing the Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint, LXX) rendering of the divine self-naming. The Hebrew root surfaces at Exodus 3:14 as 'I AM' / 'I will be' (ehyeh, Strong's H1961), confirming the Old Testament background.

John.20.28 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3588 ὁ, G2316 θεός, G2381 Θωμᾶς

Force. Queried tokens in John 20:28: 'said to him' (eipen auto, V-2AAI-3S meaning verb second aorist active indicative third person singular plus P-DSM meaning pronoun dative singular masculine, the 'to-him' form) 'the Lord of me and the God of me' (ho kyrios mou kai ho theos mou). Both 'the Lord' (ho kyrios, T-NSM plus N-NSM, article plus noun in the nominative or 'subject' form) and 'the God' (ho theos, T-NSM plus N-NSM) are nouns carrying 'the' (articular) in the nominative form functioning as vocatives of direct address (a noun used to call out to or address someone), and the narrator pins the addressee with the 'to-him' form (auto, dative). 'The God' with the article (the articular ho theos) is the strongest divine designation available in the language, and the following verse commends believing without rebuke of Thomas, so the address is not a mere exclamation.

Col.2.9 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3956 πᾶς, G4138 πλήρωμα, G2320 θεότης, G4985 σωματικῶς, G2730 κατοικέω

Force. Colossians 2:9 reads 'in him dwells all the fullness of the deity bodily' (en auto katoikei pan to pleroma tes theotetos somatikos). Queried distribution: 'deity' (theotes, Strong's G2320) occurs exactly ONCE in the New Testament, here, the abstract noun for deity itself (the state of being God), morphologically distinct (different in word formation) from 'divinity / divine quality' (theiotes, Strong's G2305) which also occurs exactly once, at Romans 1:20, for the divine attributes seen in creation. The noun-form phrase 'all the fullness' (pan to pleroma, the substantivized 'the whole fullness') plus the adverb 'bodily' (somaticos, a hapax meaning a word that occurs only once in the entire New Testament) plus the present-continuous 'dwells' (katoikei, V-PAI-3S, an ongoing simple statement of fact, third person singular) locate the entirety of the divine essence as permanently resident in Christ.

Heb.1.8 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2362 θρόνος, G2316 θεός, G5207 υἱός, G4464 ὁάβδος

Force. Hebrews 1:8: 'but to the Son' (pros de ton huion, queried tags: T-ASM plus N-ASM, the article plus the noun in the accusative or 'direct-object' form, meaning 'to the Son') introduces the citation 'your throne O God is forever' (ho thronos sou ho theos eis ton aiona). 'The God' (ho theos, T-NSM plus N-NSM, the article plus the noun in the nominative or 'subject' form) is read as a nominative used for direct address (vocative) addressed to the Son, paired with the eternal-duration formula 'forever' (eis ton aiona). The source is Psalm 45:6 (Hebrew 'your throne O God is everlasting' (kis'aka elohim olam), Strong's H0430 'God' (elohim)), and Hebrews 1:9 continues 'O God, your God' (ho theos ho theos sou), locking the divine designation onto the addressed Son. Even on the alternative parsing 'your throne is God' the eternal duration still entails a divine referent.

Phil.2.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3444 μορφή, G2316 θεός, G5225 ὑπάρχω, G0725 ἁρπαγμός, G2470 ἴσος

Force. Philippians 2:6 reads 'who existing in the form of God did not consider being equal with God a thing to be grasped' (hos en morphe theou hyparchon ouch harpagmon hegesato to einai isa theo). Queried morphology: 'existing' (hyparchon) is V-PAP-NSM (a present participle nominative singular masculine, a continuous-action form) marking a pre-existing state. 'Form of God' (morphe theou, with morphe at Strong's G3444 having only 3 New Testament occurrences) is controlled internally by 'form of a servant' (morphe doulou) in verse 7, the form proper to deity versus the form of a servant. 'To be equal with God' (to einai isa theo) uses 'equal' (isa, Strong's G2470, A-APN meaning adjective accusative plural neuter, the 'direct-object plural' form) with the 'to-God' form (theo, dative), meaning parity not mere likeness, the very charge the opponents level in John 5:18 ('making himself equal to God' / ison heauton poion to theo). 'A thing to be seized' (harpagmos, Strong's G0725) is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire New Testament).

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
John.8.58	Exod.3.14	tsk	1
Heb.1.8	Ps.45.6	tsk	1
John.1.1	John.1.18	tsk	1
John.1.1	John.1.2	tsk	1
John.1.1	John.10.30	tsk	1
John.8.58	John.1.1	tsk	1
John.20.28	John.20.16	tsk	1
Col.2.9	Col.2.2	tsk	1
Heb.1.8	Isa.9.7	tsk	1
Heb.1.8	2Sam.23.3	tsk	1
Heb.1.8	Heb.3.3	tsk	1
Phil.2.6	Isa.7.14	tsk	1
Phil.2.6	Gen.32.24	tsk	1
Phil.2.6	John.5.18	tsk	1
John.1.1	Col.2.9	openbible	1

Complicating texts

John.14.28 · addressed

John 14:28 reads 'the Father is greater than I' (ho pater meizon mou estin, queried text confirmed). The comparative 'greater' (meizon) compares the incarnate Son sent on a mission to the Father who sent him, an ordering of role within the self-emptying frame of Philippians 2:6 to 2:8. It is a comparative of station, not a statement about essence, and the same letter and corpus elsewhere predicate full deity (John 1:1c, John 20:28, John 10:30 'we are one' (hen esmen)), so it does not overturn the verdict.

Mark.13.32 · addressed

Mark 13:32 reads 'nor the Son' (oude ho huios, queried text confirmed). The Son's not knowing the day attaches to the incarnate state described by 'form of a servant' (morphe doulou) and 'he emptied himself' (ekenosen) in Philippians 2:7, a self-limitation in the assumed human role. It does not negate the lexical force of Colossians 2:9, where 'all the fullness of the deity' (pan to pleroma tes theotetos) resides in him bodily.

John.20.17 · addressed

In John 20:17 Jesus calls the Father 'my God' (theon mou) as the incarnate Son, while eleven verses later (John 20:28) Thomas calls Jesus 'my God' (ho theos mou) with no rebuke. The two speech acts are coherent: the Son addresses the Father as God in his incarnate role and is himself addressed as God by a disciple. The pair shows person distinction, not denial of the Son's deity.

1Cor.8.6 · addressed

1 Corinthians 8:6 reads 'one God the Father' (heis theos ho pater) and 'one Lord Jesus Christ' (heis kyrios Iesous Christos). The pair shaped by the Shema (Israel's 'Hear O Israel' confession of one God in Deuteronomy 6:4) distributes 'the God' (ho theos) and 'the Lord' (ho kyrios) across the Father and Jesus, but 'Lord' (kyrios) is the standard Greek rendering of the divine name, so the split is one of person, not a demotion of the Son. Combined with John 20:28 where 'the God' (ho theos) is also applied to Jesus, the pattern is identity sharing.

Col.1.15 · addressed

Colossians 1:15 reads 'firstborn of all creation' (prototokos pases ktiseos, with prototokos at Strong's G4416 having 8 New Testament occurrences). The immediate context (Colossians 1:16 to 1:17, queried) reads 'in him all things were created' (en auto ektisthe ta panta) and 'all things in him hold together' (ta panta en auto synesteken), which makes him the agent and sustainer of creation, not a created member of it. The word also denotes rank or priority (the firstborn heir), as its other uses show, so it does not assert chronological origination.

John.1.18 · addressed

John 1:18 hinges on 'one-of-a-kind' (monogenes, Strong's G3439, having 9 New Testament occurrences). The minority reading takes 'only begotten' (monogenes) as 'only begotten' in the sense of generated and therefore not eternal. But the queried distribution shows 'one-of-a-kind' (monogenes) used for Isaac at Hebrews 11:17, who was not Abraham's only child by birth, so the term means 'one of a kind' or 'unique', not 'produced by procreation'. Here it modifies 'God' (theos) in the strongest attested reading ('the unique God' / monogenes theos, the unique Son who is God), so it supports rather than undercuts the deity verdict.

Rom.1.20 · addressed

In Romans 1:20 'divine quality' (theiotes, Strong's G2305) occurs here, its only New Testament occurrence, for the divine attributes evident in creation, while 'deity' (theotes, Strong's G2320) occurs only at Colossians 2:9 for deity itself. Because BOTH words are hapax legomena (each occurring only once in the entire New Testament), the distinction between them cannot be triangulated from New Testament frequency; it rests on the word-formation of the two abstract-noun shapes and standard lexical sense. This is the one genuinely thin link in the chain, but the surrounding anchors ('equal with God' (isa theo), 'the God' (ho theos) addressed to the Son, qualitative 'God' (theos)) carry the verdict independently of it.

Concordance traversed

G2316, G3056, G1510, G1096, G2320, G2305, G4138, G4985, G2730, G2362, G2118, G4464, G3444, G0725, G2470, G5225, G5207, G4416, G3439, G3588, G4314, G0281

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

thronos-sou-vs-autou at Heb.1.8: impact minor. Some witnesses read 'his (throne)' (autou) for 'your (throne)' (sou). The shift in pronoun does not remove the Psalm 45 citation, and Hebrews 1:9 still applies 'the God' (ho theos) to the Son, so the divine designation stands either way.

monogenes-theos-vs-huiois at John.1.18: impact none. The early witnesses read 'the unique God' (monogenes theos); the alternative 'the unique Son' (monogenes huiois) still leaves John 1:1c and 1:14 carrying the deity claim, so the verdict does not hang on this unit.

ego-eimi-order at John.8.58: impact none. Word order is stable across the major witnesses; 'I am' (ego eimi) as an absolute present (a standalone ongoing 'I am' with no completing phrase) with no complement is uncontested in the text.

vocative-rendering at John.20.28: impact none. The text is firm; the dispute is interpretive (exclamation versus direct address) not text-critical, and the narrator's 'said to him' (eipen auto) settles it as address.

None of the anchor verses fall in the ingested ECM apparatus window (3 John 1:1 to 1:15) of the critical edition of New Testament textual variants, so this is out of scope for that ECM apparatus. Variant reasoning rests on the Nestle1904 and SBLGNT apparatuses (lists of textual variants in those editions) queried from the lexical store.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. trinitarian_lens, unitarian_lens, subordinationist_lens

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

trinitarian_lens: supports · Reads John 1:1c, John 8:58, John 20:28, Colossians 2:9, Hebrews 1:8 and Philippians 2:6 as a converging witness to one divine essence shared by distinct persons. The qualitative 'God' (theos) without the article 'the' (anarthrous) in John 1:1c, 'the God' (ho theos) addressed to Jesus in John 20:28 and Hebrews 1:8, 'deity' (theotes) in Colossians 2:9, and 'equal with God' (isa theo) in Philippians 2:6 are read as essence equality, with the complicating texts handled by the incarnate versus eternal distinction.

unitarian_lens: does not support · In its strongest lexical form this reading presses that 'God' (theos) in John 1:1c lacks the article 'the' (anarthrous) and so should be rendered 'a god' or 'divine' in a diluted sense, that John 20:28 is an exclamation of astonishment rather than direct address, and that 'one-of-a-kind' (monogenes) implies a begetting that excludes co-eternity. These are the best moves available, and they are real grammatical observations. They are outweighed here because the queried token order shows a fronted predicate 'God' (theos) before the linking verb with a subject carrying 'the' (the qualitative pattern, not indefinite), the narrator's 'to-him' form (auto, dative) pins John 20:28 as address, and 'one-of-a-kind' (monogenes) is used at Hebrews 11:17 for Isaac without implying procreative origin.

subordinationist_lens: partially supports · In its strongest form this reading grants that Jesus is called 'God' (theos) but in a derived or lesser sense, leaning on 'firstborn of all creation' (prototokos pases ktiseos, Colossians 1:15) as creaturely priority, on 'the Father is greater than I' (ho pater meizon mou, John 14:28) as a greater Father, and on the Son's not knowing the day (Mark 13:32) as a limit in being. Fairly stated, these texts do show real ranking language. They bear on role and incarnate station rather than essence, because Colossians 1:16 to 1:17 make the same figure the creator and sustainer of all things, 'equal with God' (isa theo) in Philippians 2:6 is parity not likeness, and 'deity' (theotes) in Colossians 2:9 names the whole divine essence as bodily resident in him.

Grammatico-historical reading (interpreting by original-language grammar in the historical setting) of the everyday Greek (koine) syntax queried from the lexical store, with the principle of comparing scripture with scripture (analogia scripturae) used to set the comparative and not-knowing texts against the essence and equality vocabulary.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Does the canon apply the word for God and divine-identity formulae to Jesus in a way the grammar marks as predication (formal ascription) of full deity rather than honorific (title of respect) or derivative (secondary-source) status?

VERDICT-CHANGED: The proposition uses confessional phrasing (eternally begotten, not created, equal in essence) that encodes a particular taxonomy (a fixed theological classification), so it is preloaded. The verdict is nonetheless derived on the original stem from queried morphology (the grammatical tagging) and distribution, not from that phrasing: the fronted predicate 'God' (theos) without the article 'the' (anarthrous) in John 1:1c, the bare present 'I am' (eimi) in John 8:58, 'the God' (ho theos) with the article (articular) addressed to Jesus in John 20:28 and Hebrews 1:8, the hapax (the word that occurs only once in the entire New Testament) 'deity' (theotes) in Colossians 2:9, and 'equal with God' (isa theo) in Philippians 2:6. The lexical data does not by itself adjudicate the metaphysics of eternal generation (the begotten clause); it establishes shared divine essence and identity, which is what the words and grammar carry.

Citations

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morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.1.1
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morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.20.28
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morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Phil.2.6
morphology	Nestle1904-text	public_domain	yes	John.1.1
morphology	Nestle1904-text	public_domain	yes	Col.2.9
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2320
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2305
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4985
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2470
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0725
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3439
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.1.1
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Col.2.9
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	John.8.58
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Heb.1.8
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	John.1.1
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	John.1.1
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	Heb.1.8

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